From:	SBC Development Control
To:	Edward Snook; Scanning
Subject:	FW: S_24_0577_MOD 106 Additional comments from South Marston Parish Council
Date:	28 July 2025 09:08:35

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Sent: 25 July 2025 13:06
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Subject: S_24_0577_MOD 106 Additional comments from South Marston Parish Council

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Open Space Strategy South Marston East S_24_0577_MOD 106

In addition to our initial submission:

Off Road Cycleways/Footpaths

As part of negotiations over the detailed design of parcels R6 and R8, it was agreed that a direct footpath/cycleway should connect the northern exit from R6 to the 'Carpenters Walk' junction with the Primary Street to enable residents to reach the main community facilities - the school and the new community hall. The Open Space Strategy should note that other features, for instance the LEAP, should be designed to accommodate the 'desire line' required by this footpath/cycleway

Elsewhere across the area covered by this Strategy, the document should take due note of the need to accommodate footpaths, cycleways and horse-riding routes as specified in the Strategic Design Code and the CADC -2 Mandatory Coding Plan.

It now appears likely that maintenance of off-road cycleways, footpaths and horse-riding routes through public open space will be the responsibility whoever takes on the maintenance responsibility for the public open space. The Open Space Strategy should include this requirement in the maintenance schedule section.

Surface Water Drainage

The developers have still not submitted any details of how one element of their Surface Water Drainage network will be achieved. This is a swale shown on plans within application S/RES/25/0836 submitted July 2025 that will carry surface water from a high point in South Marston West phase (east of Oxleaze Wood and just south of the LEAP) across Bridleway 4 to reach the area covered by this Open Space Strategy. There are, as yet, no plans available to show how this will be directed into the main Primary Street roadside drainage system in a way that will avoid flooding in the area south of the Primary Street.

Sustainability Focus : Play Area Design

Climate change has delivered long periods of either very wet or hot dry weather that

creates significant problems for maintenance and safety. Grass cracking is a real problem for all those managing play areas, particularly when it is severe enough to pull apart safety surfacing. All safety surfacing should be of the recommended depth for the equipment and secured with appropriate frequency of ties and pegs. Attention must be paid to laying safety surfacing on level, compacted ground. All equipment requiring single free-standing uprights should be adequately secured in concrete as ground contraction in hot weather increases the risk of rocking that quickly escalates to a safety problem.

No play area should include landscaped earth mounds – the higher earth dries out faster, and inevitably causes dangerous cracking which is expensive to repair each and every year.

Sylvia Brown
On behalf of SOUTH MARSTON PARISH COUNCIL

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